

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Stand up for human rights!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about social issues and the arts.
- I can talk about things that had happened.
- I can explain the sequence of events in the past.

Ask your partner:

- What qualities does it take to make social change?
- What is one issue that you are passionate about? Explain.





Let's Explore!

Do you know why **the caged bird sings***?

* "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings" is a book by Maya Angelou.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Civil rights activist and prolific writer Maya Angelou was born on April 24th, 1928, in St. Louis, Missouri.

After Maya Angelou had written *I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings*, it made history in the literary world as the first African-American nonfiction bestseller.

After her parents had divorced, Maya lived with her grandmother. She was a child of seven when she experienced a traumatic event, and she refused to speak again for five years. That's when she realized that words had immense power.

Maya was awarded a scholarship to study dance and drama in San Francisco. There she was exposed to new ideas and political activism.

Before she began her writing career, she was a singer and actor in *Porgy and Bess*. It was at this time that she began to compose lyrics and become passionate about writing.

After she had met and married Vusumzi Make, a civil rights activist, they moved to Cairo, Egypt where she was editor of *The Arab Observer*.

Soon after she returned to the US, she made a connection with Malcolm X and helped build the Organization of African-American Unity. After Malcolm X had been assassinated, Maya Angelou began working with Martin Luther King. After King had also been assassinated, Maya was overcome. She began writing to comfort her soul. She published over thirty works that include poetry and nonfiction before she died. At the end of her life, she had won many awards and honors for both her dedication to the Civil Rights Movement and for her literary legacy.





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about the arts and social issues!

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. in / Louis, / born / St. / was / activist / and / rights / Angelou / civil / . / Maya / Missouri / Writer
2. Her / . / as / made / the / bestseller / book / nonfiction / African-American / history / first
3. exposed / was / new / she / and / activism / political / ideas / There / . / to
4. she / compose / at / about / . / to / was / writing / became / passionate / time / began / It / this / and / that / lyrics
5. after / Malcolm / She / continued / work / had / . / X / been / her / assassinated



Let's Practice!

Maya's early life and influences.

Instructions: Write the correct phrases in each blank to correctly complete the sentences.

when she realized / Before she began /
when she experienced / Soon after /
was at this time that

1. She was a child of seven _____ a traumatic event, and she refused to speak again for five years.
2. That's _____ that words had immense power.
3. _____ her writing career, she was a singer and actor in *Porgy and Bess*.
4. It _____ she began to compose lyrics and became passionate about writing.
5. _____ she returned to the U.S., where she met with Malcolm X and helped build the Organization of African-American Unity.



Extension Activity

Read Maya Angelou's poem *Caged Bird*.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find the poem "Caged Bird" by Maya Angelou.
- Read the poem once or twice.
- Look up any new words.
- Read the poem again out loud.
- Discuss the imagery and meaning of the poem with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I read Maya Angelou's poem.

☐ ☐

I write down new vocabulary and look up the meaning of the words.

☐ ☐

I read the poem out loud.

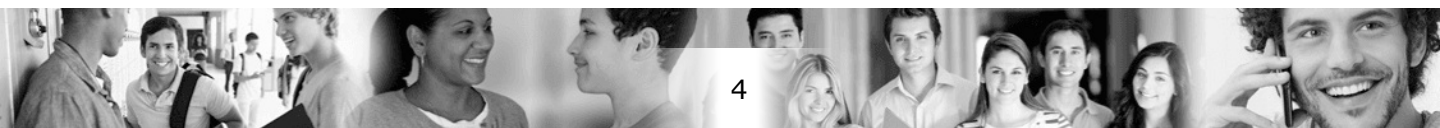
☐ ☐

I discuss the meaning of the poem with a friend.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- activist** (noun): a person who campaigns for some kind of social change
e.g. Civil rights activist and prolific writer Maya Angelou was born on April 24th, 1928, in St. Louis, Missouri.
- prolific** (adjective): producing a great number or amount of something
e.g. Civil rights activist and prolific writer Maya Angelou was born on April 24th, 1928, in St. Louis, Missouri.
- literary** (adjective): concerning the writing, study, or content of literature
e.g. After Maya Angelou had written "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings", it made history in the literary world as the first African-American nonfiction bestseller.
- African-American** (noun): an American who is from Africa, or has ancestors who came from Africa
e.g. After Maya Angelou had written "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings", it made history in the literary world as the first African-American nonfiction bestseller.
- nonfiction** (adjective): based on facts, real events, and real people
e.g. After Maya Angelou had written "I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings", it made history in the literary world as the first African-American nonfiction bestseller.
- political activism** (noun): efforts to promote, impede, or direct political change
e.g. In San Francisco she was exposed to new ideas and political activism.
- to assassinate** (verb): to murder a famous or important person in a surprise attack
e.g. After Malcolm X had been assassinated, Maya Angelou began working with Martin Luther King.
- lyrics** (noun): the words of a song
e.g. It was at this time that she began to compose lyrics and become passionate about writing.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect Tense with After

You can use the Past Perfect tense to refer to events that happened earlier in time than other events in the past.

You can use the Past Perfect in clauses with **after**.

- **After** we **had eaten** dessert, we went for a walk.

You can also use *after* + Simple Past in the time clause and Simple Past in the main clause:

- *After* we ate dessert, we went for a walk.

Because the meaning of **after** tells you which event happened first, it is not always necessary to use the Past Perfect here. Using the Simple Past is also correct.

You can use the Past Perfect similar to the Present Perfect.

The Present Perfect refers to an event that happened at an unspecified past time with a relevance to the present.

- *I have just had a baby and I'm still on maternity leave.*

(I am speaking from the present time referring to an event that happened at no specific past time, but with a relevance to now.)

In the same way, if you are talking in the past and referring to a previous past event with relevance, you can use the Past Perfect.

- *It was 2005. I **had just had** a baby and was still on maternity leave.*

(I am speaking about the past. I'm looking back at an event with relevance to another time in the past.)

You can use the Past Perfect if you want to tell a story of events from a time in the past.

- *Jennifer Lopez was a forty-six-year-old actress, singer and dancer. She **had grown up** in New York and **had begun** her career as a dancer. She **had worked** as a dancer on television shows and in music videos. She **had acted** in her first starring role in the movie "Selena".*

You can also narrate a story in the Simple Past from a time in the present.

- *Jennifer Lopez is a forty-six-year-old actress, singer and dancer. She grew up in New York and began her career as a dancer. She worked as a dancer on television shows and in music videos. She acted in her first starring role in the movie "Selena".*

While both narrations are grammatically correct, it is more common that narration in the Past Perfect does not continue for very long. Most times, the speaker switches or brings the story to a time in the present to continue the story with the Simple Past.

In addition, if you give the events of the story in the order that they happened, it is not necessary to use the Past Perfect. You can easily use the Simple Past instead.





Learning Points

Examples:

- After Maya Angelou had written "*I Know Why the Caged Bird Sings*", it made history in the literary world as the first African-American nonfiction bestseller.
- After Malcolm X had been assassinated, Maya Angelou began working with Martin Luther King.

Time Clause: Order of Past Events

You can talk about the order of events in the past by using time clauses in your sentences.

You can use different conjunctions like **after**, **before** and **when** to form time clauses to give an order to the events you are speaking about. These time words signal which actions come first or second, so you have to think carefully about the order of the events you are relating.

The time clause can either come before or after the main clause. If the time clause comes first, remember to use a comma after it.

<i>I went to bed after I brushed my teeth.</i> After I brushed my teeth, I went to bed.	<i>I took a shower before I read the newspaper.</i> Before I read the newspaper, I took a shower.	When I arrived at school, I did my homework. I did my homework when I arrived at school.
Which action happened first? brushed my teeth: 1st action went to bed: 2nd action	Which action happened first? took a shower: 1st action read the newspaper: 2nd action	Which action happened first? arrived at school: 1st action did my homework: 2nd action

Examples:

- She was a child of seven when she experienced a traumatic event and she refused to speak again for five years.
- Before she began her writing career she was a singer and actor in "*Porgy and Bess*".
- Soon after she returned to the US she made a connection with Malcolm X and helped build the Organization of African-American Unity.

